

If people didn't have principles, even subconsciously, then everybody would just do whatever they wanted, and no matter what they did, they'd be right! Needless to say, there would be utter chaos everywhere! This is why we have principles, in order to guide our behaviour. Similarly, there are principles in UX design to guide the product or service's design behaviour. After all, that's what a UX designer does!

At its core, every principle contains questions that focus on some aspect of UX design and provides a basis for further changes. Each of them guides development of the User Experience in different ways, based on the analysis of data obtained during user research. A good UX design incorporates most of these principles, if not all. This ensures that a good UX design can be replicated using these guidelines. These principles affect various factors of the design in different combinations that ultimately impact the product, service or website. Mainly, there are five factors. These are:

- ◆ **Discoverability/Learnability:** How easy is it for the user to find controls or accomplish basic tasks the first time they come across the design? How soon can they use it at the intended level of utility? How easily can they navigate the information?
- ◆ **Efficiency:** Once users have learnt to accomplish basic tasks, how quickly can they perform the task? If they need to perform the same task multiple times, at what speed can they accomplish it?
- ◆ **Memorability:** Can repeat users maintain their proficiency at utilising the design after an extended period of time of not using it?
- ◆ **System Performance/Errors:** How responsive is the interface during user interaction? What kind of errors do users make and how crippling are they? How can users recover from these errors within the framework of the design?
- ◆ **Delight/Satisfaction:** How much pleasure do users get by using the design? Is it enough for them to have an emotional connection?

The Fundamental Principle

“One cannot not communicate: Every behavior is a form of communication. Because behavior does not have a counterpart (there is no anti-behavior), it's impossible not to communicate.” - Paul Watzlawick

One cannot not communicate: This fundamental principle is often called the “First Axiom of Communication”. This is followed by one's inability to not influence, as every communication constitutes an influence on the receiver.